

Uncle May's Produce

The first data and distribution platform for Black food consumption.

Retail stores + vendor network + proprietary data layer, powering a \$120B+ underserved market with no system of record.

Closing the final \$400K SAFE tranche to activate the SBA facility and open the Hyde Park flagship June 1, 2026.

Milestones Secured

SBA Senior Debt

\$2.0M conditionally approved (Busey Bank)

Flagship LOI

Hyde Park, 10,000 sq ft selling area

General Manager

Matt Weschler, 2 prior Chicago grocery exits

Design + Architecture

Civic Projects + Food Market Designs

The Opportunity

The Gap

- 67% of Black shoppers visit 3+ stores monthly (Progressive Grocer)
- 40% say their store doesn't carry their cultural foods (McKinsey)
- Stores in Black neighborhoods stock 52% fewer produce varieties (USDA)
- No system captures Black food demand at the SKU level

The Model

- **Retail.** Curated 4,000 SKU format, 7,500-12,000 sq ft, neighborhood scale
- **Vendor.** Direct sourcing through a Black-farmer and Black-CPG network
- **Data.** SKU-level demand, pricing, and behavior aggregated across stores and the produce-box channel
- **Comparable.** Northgate Market (Hispanic-grocery analog) sold to a KKR-backed buyer in 2024 at ~\$1B+. Trader Joe's, the curated-format benchmark, generates ~\$2,200/sq ft.

Market

\$800B

U.S. Grocery Market

\$100B+

Black Grocery Spend (TAM)

\$120B+

Underserved Cultural Segment (SAM)

25-35

Beachhead: Black Women

Traction, Leadership + The Raise

Traction

Produce Box Live Orders fulfilled, SKU-level data flowing weekly into the assortment model	Consumer Validation 97% intent-to-shop, 89.6% would refer (100+ surveyed)	Projected Unit Economics \$629/sq ft Year 1, above \$500-\$600 industry avg. 35% GM, 15.3% EBITDA, 33% 5-yr IRR
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Leadership

	Anthony Ivy, CEO Chicago Booth MBA, real estate PE and M&A
	Zoe Rowell, COO 15+ yrs ops, \$3B Amazon Retail P&L
	Jua Mitchell, CFO 20+ yrs M&A/IB at Bank of America, Booth MBA
	Tara Weymon, CMO Head of Global Marketing, Unilever. VP Marketing, P&G
	Matt Weschler, GM Two prior Chicago grocery exits, current GM Wild Onion

The Raise

☐ SAFE - \$400K-\$750K - \$5M cap - 20% discount - \$25K minimum check. \$400K minimum triggers the \$2.0M SBA facility close.

Capital Stack (\$2.5M Total)

Source	Amount
Equity / equity-like (SAFE)	\$400K
Tenant Improvements	\$100K
SBA 7(a) - Busey	\$2,007K
Total	\$2,507K

Use of Funds

Use	Amount
Build-out	\$1,460K
Soft costs (A&E, permits, legal, PM)	\$445K
Initial inventory	\$250K
Pre-opening	\$60K
SG&A reserves	\$417K
Initial AP offset	(\$125K)

Why Uncle May's Wins

Three structural advantages that no competitor has assembled in a single platform.



Retail Presence

A curated 4,000 SKU neighborhood-scale format purpose-built for Black food culture. The Hyde Park flagship is the proof-of-concept for a replicable, capital-efficient store model targeting 7,500-12,000 sq ft sites in underserved urban corridors.



Vendor Network

Direct sourcing relationships with Black farmers and Black-owned CPG brands create a supply chain that is both mission-aligned and margin-accretive. This network is a durable moat that large-format competitors cannot replicate quickly.



Proprietary Data Layer

SKU-level demand, pricing, and consumer behavior aggregated across the retail channel and the live produce-box subscription. This is the first system of record for Black food consumption in the United States, and it compounds in value with every transaction.

The Analog: Northgate Market

Northgate Market

Hispanic-grocery analog. Built a culturally-focused retail and distribution platform serving an underserved segment. Sold to a KKR-backed buyer in 2024 at approximately \$1B+.

Uncle May's Produce

Black-grocery analog. Same structural thesis: cultural specificity + retail footprint + data layer = category-defining platform. Beachhead market of Black women ages 25-35 in Chicago, scaling to a national system of record.

Path to Close



**Raise \$400K
SAFE**

**Close \$2.0M
SBA**

**Open Hyde
Park**

The \$400K minimum SAFE close is the single critical-path event. It unlocks the conditionally approved \$2.0M SBA 7(a) facility at Busey Bank, funds the build-out of the Hyde Park flagship, and launches the full retail and data platform on June 1, 2026.



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